

Operations Commander (OC)

Primary function: tactical / on-scene command. You turn the Incident Commander's objectives into action on the ground.

YOU REPORT TO / REPORTING STRUCTURE

Reports to the Incident Commander (IC).

FIRST 0–3 MINUTES

- Report to IC.
- Proceed toward the incident area only when safe.
- Establish safe tactical control.
- Receive first-responder size-up.
- Identify immediate hazards, danger zones, casualties and evacuation/rescue requirements.
- Deploy trained Responders.

NEXT 3–10 MINUTES

- Establish safe/unsafe zones.
- Direct evacuation, rescue or containment.
- Assign responder teams/sectors.
- Confirm access/egress routes.
- Coordinate Medic, Fire Marshal, Security, Guides and HOD responders.
- Provide situation update to IC.

ONGOING RESPONSIBILITIES

- Direct field operations.
- Protect responder safety.
- Manage rescue, evacuation and containment.
- Control access to danger areas.
- Maintain accountability of responder teams.
- Coordinate with external responders once they arrive.
- Provide regular situation updates to IC.

DO NOT

- Do not override IC strategic decisions.
- Do not enter hazards beyond your training/PPE.
- Do not allow untrained team members into danger zones.
- Do not communicate with media.

BEFORE ALL CLEAR / HANDOVER

- Conduct/confirm final tactical sweep.
- Confirm no remaining hazards.
- Confirm all zones cleared.
- Report status to IC.
- Assist with operational debrief.

FORMS / TOOLS TO GRAB

- Applicable scenario ICS Activation Checklist
- A34 Radio Code List
- A4-TZ or A4-KE Priority Contact Card

REMEMBER

You command the scene, not the strategy. Keep the IC updated and keep every responder inside their training and PPE.